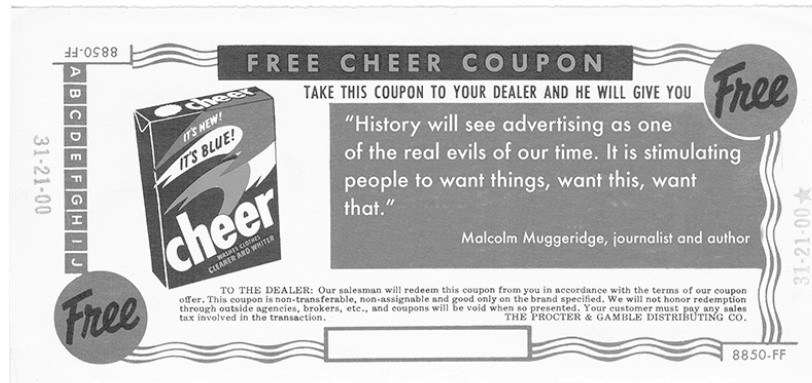


lighting and sound cues are taken into account, playing into all of our senses.



Grocery stores have long employed these kinds of tactics to increase sales. From the pleasant smell of fresh-baked bread wafting through the store, to the highest priced merchandise placed at eye-level, someone, somewhere, came up with specific marketing plans in response to the study of consumer behavior, also known as market research.

Stores use visual cues like bargain bins, hanging promotional signs and endcap displays. Or, they may compare a sale price to a list price, except that the list price has been hiked up to reflect a deeper discount. The savvy consumer might have a rudimentary understanding of the concept of loss-leaders and how companies pay to have their product featured on an endcap, but be totally unaware of the more subtle ways businesses influence public buying behavior. In fact, stores count on the majority of consumers to be blissfully ignorant of their marketing strategies.

In preparation for writing this book, I took a crash course in consumer behavior and marketing by reading books like *Consumer Behavior for*